POSITION DESCRIPTION

1. Position Number S0330

2. Explanation (show any positions replaced)
Updates USGS Standard PD

3. Reason for Submission
☐ New ☐ Redescription ☐ Reestablishment X Standardized PD ☐ Other

4. Service
☐ HQ ☐ Field

5. Subject to Identical Addition (IA) Action
☒ Yes (multiple use) ☐ No (single incumbent)

6. Position Specifications
Subject to Random Drug Testing ☐Yes ☐No
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Subject to Medical Standards/Surveillance ☐ Yes ☐ No
Telework Suitable ☐Yes ☐No
Fire Position ☐Yes ☐No
Law Enforcement Position ☐Yes ☐No

7. Financial Statement Required
☐ Executive Personnel-OGE-278
☐ Employment and Financial Interest-OGE-450
☐ None required

8. Miscellaneous
Functional Code: 31
BUS: 7777

9. Full Performance
Level Pay Plan: GS
Grade: 00

10. Position Sensitivity and Risk Designation
Non-Sensitive
☒ Non-Sensitive: Low-Risk
Public Trust
☐ Non-Sensitive: Moderate-Risk
☐ Non-Sensitive: High-Risk
National Security
☐ Noncritical-Sensitive: Moderate-Risk
☐ Noncritical-Sensitive: High-Risk
☐ Critical-Sensitive: High-Risk
☐ Special Sensitive: High-Risk

11. Position is
☐ 2-Supervisory
☐ 4-Supervisor (CSRA)
☐ 5-Management Official
☐ 6-Leader: Type I
☐ 7-Leader: Type II
☒ 8- Non Supervisory

12. Position Status
☐ Competitive ☐ SES
☒ Excepted (specify in remarks) ☐ SL/ST

13. Duty Station

14. Employing Office Location

15. Fair Labor Standards Act
☐ Exempt ☒ Nonexempt

16. Cybersecurity Code
#1: #2: #3:

17. Competitive Area Code:
Competitive Level Code:

18. Classified/Graded by	Official Title of Position	Pay Plan	Occupational Code	Grade	Initial	Date
a. Department, Bureau, or Office	Geographer	GS	0150	05	TLG	7/03/19
b. Second Level Review						

19. Organizational Title of Position *(if different from, or in addition to, official title)*

20. Name of Employee *(if vacant, specify)*

21. Department, Agency, or Establishment
U.S. Department of the Interior

a. Bureau/First Subdivision
U.S. Geological Survey

b. Second Subdivision

c. Third Subdivision

d. Fourth Subdivision

e. Fifth Subdivision

22. Supervisory Certification. *I certify that this is an accurate statement of the major duties and responsibilities of this position and its organizational relationships and that the position is necessary to carry out Government functions for which I am responsible. This certification is made with the knowledge that this information is to be used for statutory purposes relating to, but not limited to: FLSA determinations; position sensitivity and requirements; and appointment/payment of public funds. False or misleading statements may constitute violations of such statutes or their implementing regulations.*

a. Typed Name and Title of Immediate Supervisor

Signature **Date**

b. Typed Name and Title of Higher-Level Supervisor or Manager *(optional)*

Signature **Date**

23. Classification/Job Grading Certification. *I certify that this position has been classified/graded as required by Title 5, U.S. Code, in conformance with standards published by the U.S. Office of Personnel Management or, if no published standards apply directly, consistently with the most applicable published standards.*

Typed Name and Title of Official Taking Action
Tamara Lamb-Ghenee, HR Specialist (Bureau Classifier)

Signature /s/ Tamara Lamb-Ghenee **Date** 8/25/2022

24. Position Classification Standards Used in Classifying/Grading Position
Position Classification Standard for Geography Series, GS-0150, TS-47, dated August 1963.

25. Position Review	Initials	Date	Initials	Date
a. Supervisor				
b. Classifier				

Information for Employees. The standards, and information on their application, are available in the personnel office. The classification of the position may be reviewed and corrected by the agency or the U.S. Office of Personnel Management. Information on classification/job grading appeals, and complaints on exemption from FLSA, is available from the personnel office or the U.S. Office of Personnel Management.

26. Remarks
Note: The first full-performance level of professional positions is GS-09
Classification reviewed and recertified 3/21/2022

Geographer, GS-0150-05

Introduction

The incumbent serves as a trainee assigned to an office performing scientific work in geography, geographic data collection, and similar activities. As a trainee, the incumbent provides support in one or several scientific project areas supported by the assigned office.

A standard Position Description (PD) covers identical positions in multiple locations of an organization. Use of a Standard Position Description does not diminish management's responsibilities to adhere to position management principles and DOI/USGS policies.

Major Duties:
{Select the statement that applies} Select the major duty statements for the position. OR Select 5-7 major duty statements for the position. Duty statements will be the important, regular, and recurring duties and responsibilities assigned to the position. In the blank indicate the percentage of the employee's time that will be spent performing the duty. The percentages of time will total 100 percent.

Assignments may include, but are not limited to the following:

- ❒ Conducts closely prescribed testing and basic operation of a variety of water, land, and satellite-based geographic data collection instruments. Data collected may include geographic, socio-economic, physical, biological, and/or ecological information. _____%

- ❒ Uses geographic concepts, tools, and systems to populate, review, and update databases and geographic products. Reviews and verifies accuracy of data inputs from one or more standard data collection instruments. Reports anomalies in the data to higher-level scientists for review and validation. _____%

- ❒ Assists in the design and implementation of geospatial aspects of projects. Follows established guidelines aimed at modeling natural and human-induced biological and physical processes. _____%

- ❒ Records, maps, plots, or otherwise represents geospatial data, including remotely sensed data, to display and analyze using Geographic Information Systems (GIS) or other sensing instruments for monitoring temporal and/or spatial changes. _____%

- ❒ Use standard office software programs (e.g., word processing, spreadsheets) to track projects, assist in documentation and archival of data, develop reports and presentations, and communicate project status. _____%

- ❒ Contributes to reports and presentations used to inform policy, planning, and management decisions through analysis and communication of landscape characteristics and change, hydrological, biological, climatic, seismic and volcanic activity, and other phenomena. _____%

- ❒ Participates in a variety of regional and/or small-scale studies aimed at documenting changes in land use, hydrologic, and climate effects. Studies are used in decision-making regarding climatic change; economic and ecologic feasibility of land use proposals; and stewardship and management of a variety of natural resources. _____%

- ❒ Other duties as assigned

Factor Statements

FACTOR 1 - KNOWLEDGE REQUIRED BY THE POSITION

Professional knowledge of geographic principles, theories, concepts and techniques as would typically be acquired through a bachelor's degree program in geography to perform basic trainee work. Knowledge of basic geography principles, concepts of world geography, and familiarity with tools such as GIS, remote sensing equipment, and a variety of software programs for depicting the location and distribution of geographic phenomena.

FACTOR 2 - SUPERVISORY CONTROLS

The supervisor assigns work with specific and detailed instructions as to what is required and guidance as to probable results. The work is carried out under close supervision. The incumbent receives recurring technical assistance on matters not specifically covered in the original instructions. Work is reviewed in-progress and on completion for technical accuracy, adequacy, and conformance to instructions.

FACTOR 3 - GUIDELINES

Guidelines consist of manuals and publications, technical instructions, procedure manuals, bureau policies, and criteria that are detailed and directly applicable. The incumbent adheres strictly to the guidelines and consults the supervisor or higher-grade employee if guidelines lack applicability.

FACTOR 4 - COMPLEXITY

Assignments consist of specific, often unrelated, tasks designed to orient the incumbent in the practical application of theory and basic principles and concepts of cartography and geography. These detailed and routine tasks pertain to projects of higher-grade employees.

FACTOR 5 - SCOPE AND EFFECT

The purpose of the work is to orient the incumbent in the practical application of academic theory and basic principles of cartography and geography. The effect of the work is to facilitate the work of higher-grade employees.

FACTOR 6 - PERSONAL CONTACTS

Contacts are typically with employees within the immediate organization.

FACTOR 7 - PURPOSE OF CONTACTS

The contacts are generally to obtain advice and direction.

FACTOR 8 - PHYSICAL DEMANDS

- ❒ The work is usually sedentary.
- ❒ Field work may require considerable walking, lifting, bending, and climbing to collect data.

FACTOR 9 - WORK ENVIORNMENT

- ❒ Work is typically performed in an office environment.
- ❒ Field work may entail physical effort such as walking over rough terrain, climbing on landforms to place equipment, or walking on wet or slippery surfaces. Field work may take place in adverse weather conditions. A pre-employment medical examination is required.

Position Classification Standard for Geography Series, GS-0150, TS-47, dated August 1963
Introduction to the Position Classification Standards

Position Evaluation Statement

Proposed Title, Series, and Grade: Geographer, GS-0150-05

Location: DOI, USGS

Position Description Number: S0330

Series and Title Determination: Geography is the study of the physical features of the earth and the relations between human activity and the environment focusing on such phenomena as climate, land use, population distribution, and processes of geographic change. This is contrasted with work in the physical sciences, such as Cartography, where the focus is on planning, designing, constructing, and evaluating mapping systems or Geophysics where emphasis is placed on measurement, evaluation, and interpretation of geophysical phenomena related to the structure, composition, and physical properties of the earth and its atmosphere. The work is primarily focused on the relationship of land forms to human and environmental activity, and is therefore appropriately classified in the Geography series.

Grade Level Determination: The Position Classification Standard for Geography Series, GS-0150, TS-47, dated August 1963 provides grade level criteria for professional Geography. This guide in narrative format, references the grade level definitions found in Title 5 of the US Code, as well as evaluation of the nature and scope of work as well as the level of responsibility.

At the GS-05 grade level, geographers are engaged in the collection and identification of geographic information from specified source materials in accordance with established instructions and procedures. Work is developmental in nature and equips the geographer with experience in the application of professional knowledge designed provide preparation for higher level work in the field. Working knowledge of GIS and various remote sensing techniques and tools is required. Information gathered is used by scientists at higher grade levels in the completion of project segments or complete projects. Work in generally limited in scope to a specifically defined geographic area. Work that involves relatively large areas in terms of size is more limited in the depth of information required to complete the investigations.

The work requires knowledge of basic geography principles, concepts of world geography, and familiarity with tools such as GIS, remote sensing equipment, and a variety of software programs for depicting the location and distribution of geographic phenomena. At the GS-05 grade level, work is reviewed for compliance with prescribed methods and processes and is closely controlled by prescribed methods and close supervision.

FLSA Determination: Non-Exempt. Federal employees are automatically covered under the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) unless they meet one or more specific exemption criteria. As a GS-05, this position does not exercise discretion and independent judgment on matters of agency significance to meet the exemption criteria of the Fair Labor Standards Act. It is therefore considered “Non-Exempt.”

Final Classification: Geographer, GS-0150-05

References: Position Classification Standard for Geography Series, GS-0150, TS-47, dated August 1963.

Tamara Lamb-Ghenee
Human Resources Specialist
October 2, 2018